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Tehillim 1–9: The First Day

An excerpt for LinkedIn: the introduction and Chapter One, “The Tree by the Water” (Tehillim 1). The full study booklet runs to 97 pages.

בשלום יחדו אשכבה ואישן כי אתה ה' לבדד לבטח תושיבני

Aryeh Leib Thorne Toren

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An excerpt for LinkedIn: the introduction and Chapter One, "The Tree by the Water" (Tehillim 1). The full study booklet runs to 97 pages.

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Prepared on Wednesday, 11 November 2026 (1 Kislev 5787, the second day of Rosh Chodesh Kislev), Jerusalem, in the week of Parashas Toldos.
Not for sale. For study at the table, in the beis midrash and at home.

Prepared in deep partnership and cooperation with Grok and xAI

A note on sources

This LinkedIn excerpt contains only the introduction, Chapter One, and Appendix A (Tehillim 1 in full). The other eight chapters, and the other appendices, are in the full 97-page booklet, not in this file.

Every Hebrew quotation in this booklet was cut directly from the text as opened on Sefaria on 11 November 2026, with vowels and cantillation removed. Verses from Tanach are given in the English of *Tanakh: The Holy Scriptures* (Jewish Publication Society, 1985), as published on Sefaria. All other translations are my own working translations, made against the Hebrew printed beside them; where words are omitted from a long comment, the source line says so. The edition used for each text is listed in the Bibliography.

Divine Names. In English this booklet writes G-d, L-rd and Hashem. In Hebrew the Tetragrammaton and the short two-letter Name are printed as ה', and the name Elokim as אלקים. No Divine Name is printed in full.

Sources and limits. Every teaching in this booklet comes from a classical text opened for it: the Mishnah, the Talmud Bavli, *Midrash Tehillim*, Rashi, Radak, the Metzudas David, the Malbim, and the siddur. No secondary or web source is quoted. The division of Tehillim by the days of the month, in which the first day's portion is Tehillim 1–9, is referred to as a common custom; I did not open a source for its history. The Gemara's explanation of the name Kush in Tehillim 7 is not quoted.

Care in speech. These psalms speak of enemies and the wicked. This booklet keeps to the applications of the commentators, and applies their words to no living person, party or government.

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INTRODUCTION

The First Day

The first nine psalms, David and Moshe, and how this booklet reads them

The first day's portion of Tehillim holds, in small, almost everything the book does. This introduction reads the Midrash on David and Moshe, Rashi on the ten kinds of song, the Gemara on the first two psalms as one, and the threads of Kislev and Toldos.

The first day of the month

On Wednesday, 11 November 2026, the first day of the month of Kislev 5787 (the second day of Rosh Chodesh), in the week of Parashas Toldos. Many Jews say the whole book of Tehillim each month, a portion each day. In the common division printed in many books of Tehillim, the portion for the first day of the month is the first nine psalms. This booklet reads them.

They are a good place to begin, and not only because they come first. The first nine psalms hold, in small, almost everything the book of Tehillim does. There is a teaching psalm about the two ways (1), a royal psalm about the nations who rise against G-d's anointed (2), a psalm of a father fleeing his son (3), an evening psalm of trust (4), a morning prayer (5), a sick man's plea (6), a protest of innocence (7), a hymn of wonder at the heavens and at man (8), and a song of thanks for victory that becomes a prayer for the oppressed (9). Teaching, kingship, flight, sleep, prayer, illness, justice, wonder and gratitude: the whole life of a person who lives before G-d.

David and Moshe

Midrash Tehillim opens with a comparison that tells us how the Sages saw this book.

משובח שבנביאים זה משה. משובח שבמלכים זה דוד. את מוצא שכל מה שעשה משה עשה דוד. משה הוציא את ישראל ממצרים. ודוד הוציא את ישראל משעבוד מלכיות. משה עשה מלחמות בסיחון ועוג. ודוד עשה מלחמותיו של הקב"ה שנאמר (שמואל־א כה כח) כי מלחמות ה' אדוני נלחם. משה מלך על ישראל ויהודה שנאמר (דברים לג ה) ויהי בישורון מלך. ודוד מלך על ישראל ויהודה. משה קרע להם את הים. ודוד קרע להם את הנהרות שנאמר (תהלים ס ב) בהצותו את ארם נהרים. משה בנה מזבח. ודוד בנה מזבח. זה הקריב וזה הקריב. משה נתן להם חמשה חומשי תורה. וכנגדם נתן להם דוד ספר תהלים שיש בו חמשה ספרים. אשרי האיש. למנצח משכיל. מזמור לאסף. תפלה למשה. יאמרו גאולי

The most praised of the prophets and the most praised of the kings. The most praised of the prophets is Moshe; the most praised of the kings is David. You find that everything Moshe did, David did. Moshe brought Israel out of Egypt, and David brought Israel out of subjugation to the kingdoms. Moshe fought the wars of Sichon and Og, and David fought the wars of the Holy One, blessed be He, as it says, "for my lord is fighting the battles of the L-rd" (Shmuel I 25:28). Moshe was king over Israel and Yehudah, as it says, "Then He became King in Jeshurun" (Devarim 33:5), and David was king over Israel and Yehudah. Moshe split the sea for them, and David split the rivers for them, as it says, "when he fought with Aram-naharaim" (Tehillim 60:2). Moshe built an altar and David built an altar; this one offered and that one offered. Moshe gave them the five books of the Torah, and corresponding to them David gave them the book of Tehillim, which has five books: "Happy is the man," "For the leader, a maskil," "A psalm of Asaf," "A prayer of Moshe," "Let the redeemed say."

Midrash Tehillim 1

The book of Tehillim is a second Torah, in five books, given by the greatest of kings as the Torah was given by the greatest of prophets. Its first word is a blessing, as the last blessing of Moshe was.

משה בירך את ישראל באשריך. ודוד בירך באשרי

Moshe blessed Israel with "Happy are you" (Devarim 33:29), and David blessed with "Happy is the man."

Midrash Tehillim 1

Moshe's last word to Israel was "Happy are you, O Israel" (Devarim 33:29). David's first word is "Happy is the man." The Midrash hears the book of Tehillim beginning where the Torah ends.

Ten kinds of song

Rashi, at the start of his commentary, lists the ten words for song with which the book is said, and the ten people to whom tradition attributes its psalms.

בעשרה לשונות של זמר נאמר ספר זה, בנצוח, בנגון, במזמור, בשיר, בהלל, בתפלה, בברכה, בהודאה, באשרי, בהללוי־ה, כנגד עשרה בני אדם שאמרוהו, אדם, מלכי צדק, אברהם, משה, דוד, שלמה, אסף, ושלשה בני קרח, וחלוקין על ידותון

This book was said in ten expressions of song: in victory (nitzuach), in melody, in psalm, in song, in praise, in prayer, in blessing, in thanksgiving, in "happy," and in "Halleluy-ah"; corresponding to ten men who said it: Adam, Malki-tzedek, Avraham, Moshe, David, Shlomo, Asaf, and the three sons of Korach; and there is disagreement about Yedusun (Koheles Rabbah 7).

Rashi on Tehillim 1:1

The list matters for a reader of the first nine psalms. They include a psalm with "happy" (1), psalms of victory ("for the leader," lamnatze'ach: 4, 5, 6, 8, 9), psalms called mizmor (3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 9), a prayer in all but name (5), and thanks (9:2, "I will praise You, L-rd, with all my heart"). The variety is not accidental. A person comes to G-d in many voices.

One chapter or two?

The Gemara says that the first two psalms, which we print as two, were counted as one.

אשרי האיש" ו"למה רגשו גוים" חדא פרשה היא

"Happy is the man" and "Why do nations assemble" are one chapter.

Berachos 9b

כל פרשה שהיתה חביבה על דוד, פתח בה ב"אשרי" וסיים בה ב"אשרי". פתח ב"אשרי", דכתיב: "אשרי האיש". וסיים ב"אשרי", דכתיב: "אשרי כל חוסי בו

Every chapter that was dear to David, he opened with "happy" and closed with "happy." He opened with "happy," as it is written, "Happy is the man"; and he closed with "happy," as it is written, "happy are all who take refuge in Him."

Berachos 10a

The proof is in the frame: the first psalm opens with "Happy is the man," and the second psalm closes with "happy are all who take refuge in Him." The two psalms belong together as a pair: the private life of the righteous man, and the public drama of the nations and the king. A person who sits in the beis midrash and a king who faces the world are held between one "happy" and another.

Not in order

Why does the book begin where it does? Why does the psalm of Avshalom come third? *Midrash Tehillim* records an attempt to put the book in order, and its refusal.

> רבי יהושע בן לוי ביקש לישב על הספר הזה ולסדרו יצאת בת קול ואמרה לו אל תפיחו את הישן. ר' שמואל בן ר' יוסי ביקש לישב הספר הזה לפני רבי אמר לו (תהלים קיא ח) סמוכים לעד לעולם עשוים באמת וישר

Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi sought to arrange this book in order. A heavenly voice went out and said to him: Do not wake the sleeper. Rabbi Shmuel son of Rabbi Yosi sought to arrange this book before Rebbi. He said to him: "They are well founded for all eternity, wrought of truth and equity" (Tehillim 111:8).

Midrash Tehillim 3

Rebbi's answer was a verse.

> סמוכים לעד לעולם עשוים באמת וישר

well-founded for all eternity, wrought of truth and equity. (JPS)

Tehillim 111:8

"Do not wake the sleeper." The order of the psalms holds a wisdom we are not asked to reconstruct. This booklet does not try to explain why each psalm follows the one before. It does point out, where they are clear, the threads that run between them: the two ways of Tehillim 1 and the two kings of Tehillim 2; the sleep of Tehillim 3 and of Tehillim 4; the morning of Tehillim 5; the bed wet with tears in Tehillim 6.

Kislev and Toldos

Two threads run through this booklet. The first is the month. Kislev, as the companion booklet on the month explains, is the month of kesel, trust, and in one version of *Sefer Yetzirah* the month of sleep. The first nine psalms are full of both. Tehillim 3 says, "I lie down and sleep and wake again, for the L-rd sustains me." Tehillim 4 ends, "Safe and sound, I lie down and sleep; for You alone, O L-rd, keep me secure." Tehillim 9 says, "Those who know Your name trust You." The first day of Kislev opens with the sleep of the one who trusts.

The second thread is the week. Parashas Toldos is the story of a father, a mother and two sons, of blessing and flight. Tehillim 3 is the psalm of a father fleeing his son. Tehillim 1 is the tree planted beside streams of water, and Toldos is the parashah of Yitzchak's wells. Rashi reads benei ish in Tehillim 4 as "the sons of Avraham, Yitzchak and Yaakov," and quotes the verse of our parashah, "Yaakov was a mild man." *Midrash Tehillim* reads Tehillim 8 as a gallery of the fathers: Avraham, Yitzchak, Yaakov. Where the connection is in the sources, this booklet draws it.

The order of this booklet

Each of the nine chapters reads one psalm, with the commentaries of Rashi, Radak, the Metzudas David and the Malbim, the Midrash on Tehillim, and the Gemara where it speaks of the psalm. Each ends with questions for the table. The appendices give all nine psalms in full, in Hebrew and English, and Rashi's commentary on them in the original Hebrew.

CHAPTER ONE

The Tree by the Water

Tehillim 1: two ways, a session of scoffers, and the Torah that becomes "his"

The book opens with a man who did not walk, stand or sit with the wrong company. This chapter reads Rashi, Radak, the Metzudas and the Malbim, the Mishnah in Avos and the Gemara in Avodah Zarah, with Yitzchak's wells in Parashas Toldos.

Two ways

> אשרי־האיש אשר לא הלך בעצת רשעים ובדרך חטאים לא עמד ובמושב לצים לא ישב כי אם־בתורת ה' חפצו ובתורתו יהגה יומם ולילה

Happy is the man who has not followed the counsel of the wicked, or taken the path of sinners, or joined the company of the insolent; rather, the teaching of the L-RD is his delight, and he studies that teaching day and night. (JPS)

Tehillim 1:1–2

The book of Tehillim begins with a man who did not do three things, and did one. He did not walk in the counsel of the wicked, stand in the path of sinners, or sit in the company of scoffers. He delighted in the Torah of Hashem and studied it day and night.

Rashi reads the three verbs as a descent.

> אשוריו של איש ותהלותיו של אדם אלו הם אשר לא הלך, כי מתוך שלא הלך לא עמד, ומתוך שלא עמד לא ישב

"Happy is the man": the praises of a man and his glories are these: that he did not walk. For since he did not walk, he did not stand; and since he did not stand, he did not sit.

Rashi on Tehillim 1:1

Walk, stand, sit. A person does not begin by sitting with scoffers. He begins by walking past, then he stops to listen, then he sits down. The psalm praises the man who did not take the first step, because the first step leads to the rest.

The session of scoffers

What is a moshav letzim, a "company of scoffers"? Rashi links it to the next verse.

כי אם בתורת ה' חפצו. הא למדת, שמושב לצים מביאו לידי בטול תורה

"Rather, the teaching of the L-rd is his delight": so you have learned that a session of scoffers brings a person to neglect of Torah (Avodah Zarah 18b).

Rashi on Tehillim 1:2

The scoffers are not described as wicked. They may be clever and pleasant. Their sin is that their company crowds out Torah. The Mishnah in Avos says the same thing in a sharper form.

רבי חנינא בן תרדיון אומר, שנים שיושבין ואין ביניהן דברי תורה, הרי זה מושב לצים, שנאמר (תהלים א) ובמושב לצים לא ישב. אבל שנים שיושבין ויש ביניהם דברי תורה, שכינה שרויה ביניהם, שנאמר (מלאכי ג) אז נדברו יראי ה' איש אל רעהו ויקשב ה' וישמע ויכתב ספר זכרון לפניו ליראי ה' ולחשבי שמו

Rabbi Chanina ben Teradyon says: Two who sit together and there are no words of Torah between them, this is a session of scoffers, as it says, "nor sat in the company of scoffers." But two who sit together and there are words of Torah between them, the Shechinah rests between them, as it says, "In this vein have those who revere the L-rd been talking to one another. The L-rd has heard and noted it, and a scroll of remembrance has been written at His behest concerning those who revere the L-rd and esteem His name" (Malachi 3:16).

Pirkei Avos 3:2

Two people who sit together without words of Torah: that is already a session of scoffers. Two who sit with words of Torah: the Shechinah rests between them. There is no neutral table.

His delight

The Gemara in Avodah Zarah finds in "his delight" a rule for learning.

"כי אם בתורת ה' חפצו", אמר רבי: אין אדם לומד תורה אלא ממקום שלבו חפץ, שנאמר: "כי אם בתורת ה' חפצו". לוי ורבי שמעון ברבי יתבי קמיה דרבי, וקא פסקי סידרא. סליק ספרא, לוי אמר: לייתו [לן] משלי, רבי שמעון ברבי אמר: לייתו [לן] תילים. כפייה ללוי ואייתו תילים, כי מטו הכא "כי אם בתורת ה' חפצו", פריש רבי ואמר: אין אדם לומד תורה אלא ממקום שלבו חפץ. אמר לוי: רבי, נתת לנו רשות לעמוד

"Rather, the teaching of the L-rd is his delight." Rebbi said: A person learns Torah only from the place his heart desires, as it says, "rather, the teaching of the L-rd is his delight." Levi and Rabbi Shimon son of Rebbi were sitting before Rebbi, and finishing a section. The book was concluded. Levi said: Let them bring us Mishlei. Rabbi Shimon son of Rebbi said: Let them bring us Tehillim. They overruled Levi and brought Tehillim. When they reached here, "rather, the teaching of the L-rd is his delight," Rebbi explained and said: A person learns Torah only from the place his heart desires. Levi said: Rebbi, you have given us permission to stand up.

Avodah Zarah 19a

A person learns only from the place his heart desires. The story is charming: Rebbi's son wanted Tehillim and Levi wanted Mishlei; when they reached this verse Rebbi explained it, and Levi said, "You have given us permission to stand up," half joking, that if the heart rules, he could leave. The point holds. Learning begins where the heart is drawn.

Rava reads the end of the verse with a famous change of pronoun.

ואמר רבא: בתחילה נקראת על שמו של הקדוש ברוך הוא, ולבסוף נקראת על שמו, שנאמר: "בתורת ה' חפצו", "ובתורתו יהגה יומם ולילה

And Rava said: At first it is called by the name of the Holy One, blessed be He, and in the end it is called by his own name, as it says, "the teaching of the L-rd is his delight," and "he studies his teaching day and night."

Avodah Zarah 19a

ובתורתו יהגה. בתחלה היא נקראת תורת ה', ומשעמל בה היא נקראת תורתו

"And he studies his teaching": at first it is called "the Torah of Hashem," and once he has toiled in it, it is called "his Torah" (Avodah Zarah 19a).

Rashi on Tehillim 1:2

At the start of the verse, it is "the Torah of Hashem." By the end it is "his Torah." What a person toils in becomes his. The Torah is given; it is also earned, and once earned it bears the name of the one who earned it.

Rava adds a piece of practical advice.

ואמר רבא: לעולם ליגריס איניש, ואף על גב דמשכח, ואף על גב דלא ידע מאי קאמר, שנאמר: "גרסה נפשי לתאבה", "גרסה" כתיב ולא כתיב "טחנה"

And Rava said: A person should always go over his learning, even if he forgets, and even if he does not understand what he is saying, as it says, "My soul is consumed (garsah) with longing" (Tehillim 119:20): it says "garsah," crushed, and not "ground."

Avodah Zarah 19a

Go over it, even if you forget, even if you do not yet understand. Yehoshua received the same command when he took up the leadership after Moshe.

לא־ימוש ספר התורה הזה מפיך והגית בו יומם ולילה למען תשמר לעשות ככל־הכתוב בו כי־אז תצליח את־דרכך ואז תשכיל

Let not this Book of the Teaching cease from your lips, but recite it day and night, so that you may observe faithfully all that is written in it. Only then will you prosper in your undertakings and only then will you be successful. (JPS)

Yehoshua 1:8

The tree

והיה כעץ שתול על־פלגי־מים אשר פריו יתן בעתו ועלהו לא־יבול וכל אשר־יעשה יצליח

He is like a tree planted beside streams of water, which yields its fruit in season, whose foliage never fades, and whatever it produces thrives. (JPS)

Tehillim 1:3

Radak explains the image.

והיה כעץ דמה האדם הטוב לעץ שתול על פלגי מים ואמר: האדם שיסור מרע ויעשה טוב הנה הוא כעץ השתול על פלגי מים שהוא שבע לעולם, כן הוא ישמח לעולם בחלקו, אם מעט אם הרבה יאכל. ופרוש פלגי מים: שיהא פלג מים מזו הפאה ופלג מים מזו הפאה ויעברו תחתיו ולעולם הוא עליהם

"He is like a tree": he compares the good man to a tree planted beside streams of water, and says: the man who turns from evil and does good is like a tree planted beside streams of water, which is always satisfied; so he will always be glad in his portion, whether he eats little or much. And the meaning of "streams of water": that there is a stream of water on this side and a stream of water on that side, and they pass beneath it, and it is always over them.

Radak on Tehillim 1:3

A tree planted beside streams of water is "always satisfied"; so the righteous man is content with his portion, whether little or much. The streams flow on both sides and

beneath; the tree does not have to go looking for water. The Metzudas reads the image as a picture of blessing that carries over to the next generation.

והיה. ובעבור זה היה גמול שכרו להיות דומה לאילן הנטוע במקום המים שמגדל פירותיו בזמנו ואף העלים אינם כומשים בעבור מרבית הלחלוחית ושפע הרטיבות כי כן האיש הזה משופע ברוב טובה מבלי מחסור וכאומר הנה מגמול השכר ניכר יושר דרכו וכל אשר יעשה. ר"ל ובכל הנטיעות אשר ינטעו ממנו יצליח להיות כמותו וכן צאצאי האיש הזה יהיו כמוהו

"He is": and because of this his reward is to be like a tree planted in a place of water, which grows its fruit in its season, and even its leaves do not wither because of the abundance of moisture. So this man is blessed with much good, without lack. … "And whatever he does prospers": that is, in all the saplings planted from it, it succeeds in making them like itself; so the offspring of this man will be like him.

Metzudas David on Tehillim 1:3 (words omitted)

Rashi reads "whose foliage never fades" as a lesson about the conversation of the learned.

ועלהו לא יבול. אפלו הפסלת שבו לצרך היא. שיחתן של תלמידי חכמים לצרך היא וצריכה למוד

"And whose foliage never fades": even the leftover parts of it are useful. The ordinary conversation of Torah scholars is useful and needs study (Avodah Zarah 19b).

Rashi on Tehillim 1:3

Even the leaves are useful; even the small talk of Torah scholars needs study. A life planted by the water is good all the way through, not only in its fruit.

The tree and the wells of Toldos

Parashas Toldos, read on Shabbos, 14 November 2026, is the story of Yitzchak in a year of famine. He sowed in the land of the Pelishtim and reaped a hundredfold.

ויזרע יצחק בארץ ההוא וימצא בשנה ההוא מאה שערים ויברכהו ה׳

Isaac sowed in that land and reaped a hundredfold the same year. The L-RD blessed him, (JPS)

Bereishis 26:12

Then he dug wells, and found "a well of living water."

ויחפרו עבדי־יצחק בנחל וימצאו־שם באר מים חיים

But when Isaac's servants, digging in the wadi, found there a well of spring water, (JPS)

Bereishis 26:19

The Pelishtim fought over the wells and he moved on and dug again, until he found a place where there was no quarrel. The tree of Tehillim 1 is planted by water. Yitzchak, in a land of famine, found the water and planted himself beside it. The man who does not sit in the company of scoffers, and whose delight is in the Torah of Hashem, is doing what Yitzchak did: digging until he reaches living water.

Chaff

> לא־כן הרשעים כי אם־כמץ אשר־תדפנו רוח על־כן לא־יקמו רשעים במשפט וחטאים בעדת צדיקים כי־יודע ה' דרך צדיקים ודרך רשעים תאבד

Not so the wicked; rather, they are like chaff that wind blows away. Therefore the wicked will not survive judgment, nor will sinners, in the assembly of the righteous. For the L-RD cherishes the way of the righteous, but the way of the wicked is doomed. (JPS)

Tehillim 1:4–6

The wicked are not like the tree. They are "like chaff that wind blows away," without roots or weight. Rashi explains the last verse.

> כי יודע ה' וגו'. לפי שהוא יודע דרך צדיקים, ולפניו הוא להכירה תמיד, ודרך רשעים שנואה בעיניו ומעבירה מלפניו, על כן לא תהא הקמת רגל לרשעים ליום הדין, ולחטאים ליכתב בעדת צדיקים

"For the L-rd cherishes the way of the righteous": because He knows the way of the righteous, and it is before Him to recognise it always; and the way of the wicked is hateful in His eyes and He removes it from before Him. Therefore the wicked will have no standing on the day of judgement, and sinners will not be inscribed in the assembly of the righteous.

Rashi on Tehillim 1:6

G-d "knows" the way of the righteous: it is before Him always. The way of the wicked He removes from before Him, and so it perishes.

Happiness and success

The Malbim begins his commentary with a distinction worth carrying through the whole book.

> ויש הבדל בין מאושר ובין מצליח, ההצלחה הוא בענינים עולמיים בחיי העולם הזה, והאושר הוא בענינים הנפשיים בחיי העולם הבא

There is a difference between being happy (me'ushar) and being successful. Success is in worldly matters, in the life of this world; and happiness is in matters of the soul, in the life of the World to Come.

Malbim on Tehillim 1:1

Success is in the things of this world; happiness is in the things of the soul. The Malbim continues that a person shares wealth and bodily strength with animals, some of which find their food more easily than man. What belongs to a person as a person is the perfection of the soul. The first word of Tehillim, ashrei, is not a promise of success. It is a description of a life whose roots are in the right place, and that is why it can be "always satisfied," whether its portion is great or small.

For the table

1. Rashi says walking leads to standing and standing to sitting. Where is the first step you need to avoid?
2. Rebbi says a person learns only where his heart desires. What part of Torah does your heart desire?
3. At first it is "the Torah of Hashem," then "his Torah." What have you toiled in until it became yours?
4. Radak says the tree is content whether its portion is great or small. What helps you be content?

Appendix A. Tehillim 1 in full

Hebrew from the Sefaria Miqra text (vowels removed); English from Tanakh: The Holy Scriptures (Jewish Publication Society, 1985), via Sefaria, opened 11 November 2026, with divine names written G-d and L-rd and the Hebrew Divine Names replaced as explained in the note on sources.

1 אשרי־האיש אשר לא הלך בעצת רשעים ובדרך חטאים לא עמד ובמושב לצים לא ישב

Happy is the man who has not followed the counsel of the wicked, or taken the path of sinners, or joined the company of the insolent;

2 כי אם־בתורת ה' חפצו ובתורתו יהגה יומם ולילה

rather, the teaching of the L-RD is his delight, and he studies that teaching day and night.

3 והיה כעץ שתול על־פלגי־מים אשר פריו יתן בעתו ועלהו לא־יבול וכל אשר־יעשה יצליח

He is like a tree planted beside streams of water, which yields its fruit in season, whose foliage never fades, and whatever it produces thrives.

4 לא־כן הרשעים כי אם־כמץ אשר־תדפנו רוח

Not so the wicked; rather, they are like chaff that wind blows away.

5 על־כן לא־יקמו רשעים במשפט וחטאים בעדת צדיקים

Therefore the wicked will not survive judgment, nor will sinners, in the assembly of the righteous.

6 כי־יודע ה' דרך צדיקים ודרך רשעים תאבד

For the L-RD cherishes the way of the righteous, but the way of the wicked is doomed.

Glossary

Achitofel. David's counsellor who joined the rebellion of Avshalom.

Ashrei. "Happy" or "fortunate"; the first word of Tehillim.

Avshalom. Son of David who rebelled against him (Shmuel II 15–18).

Beis midrash. House of study.

Chafetz Chaim. Rabbi Yisrael Meir Kagan (1839–1933), author of the classic work on the laws of speech.

Doeg. Shaul's chief herdsman, who informed against David (Shmuel I 22).

Gog and Magog. The war of the nations against Israel at the end of days (Yechezkel 38–39).

Kesel. Trust; from the root k-s-l, which gives the name of the month Kislev.

Lamnatze'ach. "For the leader"; a common heading in Tehillim.

Malbim. Rabbi Meir Leibush Weiser (1809–1879), commentator on all of Tanach.

Metzudas David. Commentary on the Prophets and Writings by Rabbi David Altschuler and his son Rabbi Yechiel Hillel (eighteenth century).

Midrash Tehillim. The classical midrash on the book of Tehillim, also called Shocher Tov.

Mizmor. A psalm sung with an instrument.

Moshav letzim. A "session of scoffers" (Tehillim 1:1).

Radak. Rabbi David Kimchi (1160–1235), grammarian and commentator, of Narbonne.

Rashi. Rabbi Shlomo Yitzchaki (1040–1105), the foremost commentator on Tanach and Talmud.

Reish Lakish. Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish, third-century Amora of the Land of Israel.

Selah. A word in Tehillim marking a pause or the end of a section.

Shechinah. The Divine Presence.

Shiggaion. An obscure word in the heading of Tehillim 7; read by the Sages as "error."

Tachanun. Supplications said after the Amidah on ordinary weekdays.

Yetzer hara, yetzer tov. The evil and good inclinations.

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All glory to the Ribono shel Olam · Errors are mine

Aryeh Leib Thorne Toren